Introduction

When you enter into a dark room, nothing is visible. The moment you switch on the light, everything in the room becomes visible. How do we see things with our eyes? When you look at this book, the light falling on the book is reflected and enters your eyes. Light is a type of energy that helps us to see all the things around us. Light can be detected by the human eye. We all know that light is essential for vision. Let us see more about light in this chapter

DO YOU KNOW?

Light is the only source of energy for plants. So, they entirely depend on light. People and animals derive energy from carbohydrates, protein and fat through their food. Plants produce food using the energy from Sunlight, carbon-di-oxide and water by the process called as Photosynthesis. Sunlight acts a vital role in the process of photosynthesis.



Sources of Light.

Objects which are able to emit light are known as light sources. Light rays can come from different sources. There are two types of sources of light.

1. Natural sources of light
2. Artificial sources of light

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Natural Sources of light

Sources which emit light naturally are known as natural sources of light. The Sun is the primary and the major source of natural light. Stars also produce light, in the same way as the Sun do. However, as they are much farther away than the Sun, the light from them are too weak. The moon provides light, particularly in the night. Some living organisms have the ability to produce light named by **bioluminescence**. It is the effect of certain chemical reactions occurring in the organism. Fireflies, jellyfish, glow worm, certain deep sea plants and some microorganisms can emit light naturally.

Artificial Sources of light

Apart from the natural sources, light can also be produced artificially. The different light sources that are able to produce light artificially can be put under the following categories.

DO YOU KNOW?

Is the moon a luminous object?

The moon provides light as well, but it cannot produce light by its own. The light emitted by the Moon is the light of the Sun reflected towards the Earth. When we see the Moon, we see only the Moon's lighted part. Thus, half of the moon is always facing the Sun and receiving light from it. Hence, we receive light from the moon.



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